NAME: _____ CLASS: _____ TEACHER: _____

KEY TOPIC 3 • 1558–1588

Elizabethan Society in the Age of Exploration, 1558–88

ROANOKE COLONY EXPEDITION • 1585

The Secotan Leader

Painted from life by English artist and governor **John White** during Sir Walter Raleigh's first Virginian expedition to Roanoke Island in 1585.

Specification Anchor: Early contacts, Algonquian governance, and the causes of friction in Elizabethan overseas exploration.



VISUAL PRIMARY EVIDENCE

Material Culture & Regalia

- **Copper Gorget:** Prestigious trade adornment denoting high Algonquian social rank.
- **Hair & Feathers:** Traditional roach hairstyle with copper bead and shaved right side for archery.
- **Fringed Deerskin:** Tanned apron denoting ceremonial warrior status.

British Museum Collection • Registration 1906,0509.1.21

HISTORICAL PRIMARY RECORD: A Chief of the Secotan (Carolina Algonquian) (1585) **BRITISH MUSEUM • 1906,0509.1.21 • LONDON**

EXAM FOCUS **Q1(a) Feature:** 2m [3 min] • **Q1(b) Feature:** 2m [3 min] • **Q2 Causation:** 12m [18 min] **TARGET GRADE:** ☐

PEARSON EDEXCEL GCSE SPECIFICATION FRAMEWORK • KEY TOPIC 3

4 MODULAR ENQUIRIES

TOPIC 3.1 • EDUCATION AND LEISURE

- Education in the home and schools.
- Sport, pastimes and the theatre.

TOPIC 3.2 • THE 'PROBLEM' OF THE POOR

- The reasons for the increase in poverty and vagabondage during these years.
- The changing attitudes and policies towards the poor.

TOPIC 3.3 • EXPLORATION AND VOYAGES OF DISCOVERY

- Factors prompting exploration, including the impact of new technology on ships and sailing and the drive to expand trade.
- The reasons for, and significance of, Drake's circumnavigation of the globe.

TOPIC 3.4 • ATTEMPTED COLONISATION OF VIRGINIA

- Reasons for the attempted colonisation of Virginia, including the significance of Raleigh.
- Reasons for the failure of the first settlement in Virginia.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 1: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 3)

Instructions: As you study each enquiry lesson, complete the timeline missions by sketching and annotating in the corresponding dual-coding sketchpads below.

1572 • The Vagabonds Act

Key Topic 3.2

Parliament passes the 1572 Vagabonds Act, creating a legal distinction between the 'deserving poor' (elderly and sick) and 'idle beggars'. Vagrants over 14 are whipped and burned through the ear; repeat offenders face execution.

1576 • Act for Relief of the Poor & Burbage Builds 'The Theatre'

Key Topic 3.1

The 1576 Poor Act orders town councils to provide wool and raw materials to put the unemployed to work, creating 'Houses of Correction' (Bridewells). In the same year, actor James Burbage constructs 'The Theatre' in Shoreditch, launching Elizabethan public drama.

1577 • Grammar School Expansion & Humanist Curriculum

Key Topic 3.1

Over 70 new grammar schools are founded during Elizabeth's reign. The sons of the gentry and yeomanry study Latin, Greek, rhetoric, and classical history from dawn to dusk, fostering a highly literate administrative and legal class.

LIVING TIMELINE • PART 2: CHRONOLOGICAL ANCHORS (KEY TOPIC 3)

Instructions: Complete the dual-coding sketches to permanently anchor these chronological turning points in long-term memory.

1577–1580 • Drake's Circumnavigation & Scientific Sailing

Key Topic 3.3

Using new navigation technology including the astrolabe, magnetic compass, and quadrant, Francis Drake navigates through treacherous waters, claims 'Nova Albion' (California) for Elizabeth, and returns with a 4,700% return for his financial backers.

1584 • Raleigh Granted Royal Patent for Virginia

Key Topic 3.4

Elizabeth grants Sir Walter Raleigh a royal charter to discover and colonise 'remote heathen and barbarous lands'. Raleigh names the territory 'Virginia' in honour of the Virgin Queen, raising funds from London merchants for private colonisation.

1585–1586 • The First Roanoke Settlement & Failure

Key Topic 3.4

107 male colonists under Ralph Lane settle Roanoke Island. The flagship Tiger grounds, ruining seed crops; relations with Chief Wingina turn violent, and when Francis Drake arrives in June 1586, the starving colonists abandon the settlement.

Did Elizabethan education and leisure reflect a true "Golden Age" for all social classes?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1558–1580s • Why did Elizabethan attitudes towards social hierarchy limit educational opportunity?

- 30% Men vs 10% Women Can Read
- Petty Schools & Dame Schools for Basics
- Reinforcing Great Chain of Being

2 1558–1580s • How did grammar schools provide a route for sons of the gentry and merchants to rise in society?

- Over Seventy New Endowed Foundations
- Classical Latin & Rhetoric Curriculum
- Social Mobility for Middling Sons

3 1558–1580s • How did the education of the nobility differ from schooling provided to the middling classes?

- Private Tutors in Aristocratic Homes
- Oxford & Cambridge College Expansions
- Inns of Court London Legal Training

4 1558–1580s • How did leisure pursuits reflect both deep social divisions and shared national culture?

- Hunting, Hawking & Fencing for Elites
- Violent Folk Football & Archery for Commoners
- Universal Paris Garden Bear-Baiting

5 1576–1588 • Why did the theatre attract enormous popularity while provoking intense Puritan opposition?

- Purpose-Built Venues (Red Lion & Rose)
- Penny Groundlings Mingle with Gentry
- Puritans Condemn Immorality & Disease

"The Theatre (1576): The first permanent playhouse in London, built outside the city walls in Shoreditch."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B)

Score: / 12

Explain why education expanded in Elizabethan England. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • Grammar schools • Humanist ideas ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

Enquiry 3.1: Education and leisure in Elizabethan England • Question 2 Explain Why Continued

Score: / 12

Conclude your question 2 explain why and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of Elizabethan grammar schools. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of Elizabethan theatres. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 2). In Milestone 2, sketch James Burbage's 'The Theatre' with groundlings in the pit and nobility in the galleries. ← **Pages 2–3**

"Extended writing: analyse how Elizabethan education reinforced rigid social class hierarchies."

Why did poverty and vagrancy become the greatest domestic fear in Elizabethan society?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1558–1580s • How did the relationship between population growth and food supply generate severe poverty?

- Demographic Surge from 3m to 4m
- Consecutive Harvest Failures Drive Scarcity
- Falling Real Wages for Farm Labourers

2 1558–1580s • Why did the expansion of sheep farming cause widespread rural unemployment and eviction?

- Wool Accounts for 80% of English Exports
- Hedging Common Land for Low-Labour Flocks
- Eviction of Open-Field Tenant Cottagers

3 1558–1570s • Why did Elizabethan authorities draw such a sharp distinction between the 'deserving' and 'idle' po...

- Harman's Caveat for Common Cursitors Book
- Deserving Elderly Versus Idle Beggars
- Dread of Social Unrest & Treasonous Riot

4 1572 • How did the 1572 Act combine harsh criminal punishment with the first compulsory tax for relief?

- Compulsory Parish Poor Rate Tax
- Overseers Appointed to Distribute Relief
- Ear-Boring with Hot Iron for Repeat Vagrants

5 1576 • Why did the 1576 Act represent a major shift in the state's responsibility for unemployment?

- Parishes Provide Raw Wool, Flax & Hemp
- County Bridewells Compel Hard Labour
- Foundation for Elizabethan 1601 Statute

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B) | **Score: / 20**

"The main reason for the increase in poverty in Elizabethan England was bad harvests." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

You may use in your answer: • Enclosure of land • Population growth ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *To a large extent, it can be argued that... • A decisive factor supporting this view was... • Specifically, this was important because... • On the other hand, an alternative perspective is that... • In particular, ... • In conclusion, the decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

 Score: / 20

Conclude your question 3 evaluative essay and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2019 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the 1572 Vagabonds Act. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2022 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the 1576 Act for Relief of the Poor. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 1). In Milestone 1, sketch the branding iron of the 1572 Vagabonds Act alongside the wool stockpiles of the 1576 Poor Act. ← **Pages 2–3**

Did Drake circumnavigate the globe for geographic science, national glory, or legalised piracy?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1558–1575 • How did advances in navigational science make oceanic exploration feasible for English captains?

- Astrolabes & Quadrants Measure Latitude
- Mercator Projection Global Maps (1569)
- Navigation Away from Known Coastlines

2 1558–1577 • How did changes in galleon design and gun placement give English sailors an advantage at sea?

- Low Forecastles & Triangular Lateen Sails
- Culverin Cannons on Four-Wheel Carriages
- Manoeuvrable Tacking in Severe Atlantic Weather

3 1550s–1570s • Why did English merchants establish joint-stock companies to explore new global trade routes?

- Antwerp Cloth Market Collapse
- Muscovy & Levant Joint-Stock Companies
- Frobisher & Davis Arctic Ice Expeditions

4 1577–1580 • Why did Drake's circumnavigation represent a direct challenge to the Spanish Empire?

- Pelican Renamed Golden Hind at Horn
- Strait of Magellan Gale Storm Survival
- Claims Nova Albion (California) for Crown

5 1580–1588 • How did the success of Drake's circumnavigation alter England's position on the world stage?

- £140,000 Spanish Bullion Cargo Returns
- 4,700% Financial Profit Pays Crown Debt
- Proves England Can Challenge Spanish Seas

"New navigation tech: The astrolabe measured stars, but Drake's daring navigated the globe."

Question 2: Explain Why [12 marks • 18 mins] EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B) Score: / 12

Explain why Drake circumnavigated the globe in 1577–1580. [12 marks]

You may use in your answer: • Attacking Spanish colonies • Exploring new trade routes ***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *One main reason was that... • For example, ... • This was important because... • Another key factor was... • In particular, ... • Overall, the most decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

Enquiry 3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery • Question 2 Explain Why Continued

Score: / 12

Conclude your question 2 explain why and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2021 (Q1B)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of new navigational technology in the Elizabethan era. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2021 (Q1A)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of Drake's circumnavigation of the globe. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 4). In Milestone 4, sketch Drake's route through the Straits of Magellan up to Nova Albion and around the Cape of Good Hope. ← **Pages 2–3**

Why did Walter Raleigh's first American colony at Roanoke collapse into disaster by 1586?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1584 • Why did Raleigh and the Elizabethan court believe an American colony was vital to England?

- Royal Grant to Explore & Settle Lands
- Reduce Trade Dependence on Rivals
- Naval Base for Caribbean Privateering

2 1584–1585 • Why did the social composition and skills of the 1585 colonists create severe vulnerabilities?

- 107 Gentlemen Soldiers & No Farmers
- Grenville Fleet & Ralph Lane Army Discipline
- Manteo & Wanchese Native Translators

3 1585–1586 • How did environmental accidents and food dependency undermine the first Roanoke settlement?

- Flagship Tiger Runs Aground on Sandbar
- Seawater Ruins Grain Seeds & Provisions
- Disastrous Reliance on Secotan Fish Weirs

4 1586 • Why did armed conflict with the Secotan force the complete abandonment of the 1585 colony?

- Silver Cup Dispute Leads to Village Burning
- Ralph Lane Ambush Kills Chief Wingina
- Drake Arrives to Evacuate Starving Settlers

5 1587–1590 • What crucial lessons did the failure of the Roanoke expeditions provide for future English colonies?

- 118 Civilian Settlers Led by John White
- Spanish War Impounds Relief Shipping
- Template for 1607 Jamestown Settlement

Question 3: Evaluative Essay [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG • 25 mins]

EDEXCEL PAPER 2 (1HI0/2B) | **Score: / 20**

"The lack of supplies was the main reason for the failure of the Roanoke colony in 1585." How far do you agree? Explain your answer. [16 marks + 4 marks SPaG]

You may use in your answer:	• Relations with Native Americans	• The damage to the Tiger	***(You must also use information of your own.)***

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES: *To a large extent, it can be argued that... • A decisive factor supporting this view was... • Specifically, this was important because... • On the other hand, an alternative perspective is that... • In particular, ... • In conclusion, the decisive reason was... because...*

Write your response in the space provided below: *(Response continues on facing page)*

 Score: / 20

Conclude your question 3 evaluative essay and provide your sustained historical verdict below:

• QUESTION 1 PRACTICE: DESCRIBE ONE FEATURE [2 × 2M = 4 MARKS • 6 MINS]

Q1 Total: / 4

Q1(A) **EDEXCEL JUNE 2018 (Q1B)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of Walter Raleigh's plans for colonising Virginia. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this was evident when...*

Q1(B) **EDEXCEL NOVEMBER 2020 (Q1B)** **Mark: / 2**

Describe one feature of the failure of the 1585 Roanoke settlement. [2 marks]

Target: AO1 (2m) • *Feature: One key feature was that... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that...*

TIMELINE MISSION Turn to Pages 2–3 (Milestone 5). In Milestone 5, sketch the grounded flagship Tiger losing its seed grain and gunpowder on the Outer Banks. ← Pages 2–3

STUDENT ASSESSMENT RECORD • KEY TOPIC 3 TRACKER

Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558–1588 • Elizabethan Society in the Age of Exploration, 1558–88

PUPIL: _____ **TARGET GRADE:** ☐ **PREDICTED:** ☐ **ATTITUDE:** 1 • 2 • 3 • 4 • 5

#	ENQUIRY / SPECIFICATION FOCUS	DO NOW (10M)	Q1(A) FEAT (2M)	Q1(B) FEAT (2M)	EXTENDED TASK	MODULE TOTAL
1	**KT3.1: Education and leisure in Elizabethan England** *"Did Elizabethan education and leisure reflect a true "Golden Age" for all social classes?"*	/ 10	/ 2	/ 2	Q2 Explain: / 12	/ 26
2	**KT3.2: The 'problem' of the poor** *"Why did poverty and vagrancy become the greatest domestic fear in Elizabethan society?"*	/ 10	/ 2	/ 2	Q3 Essay: / 20	/ 34
3	**KT3.3: Exploration and voyages of discovery** *"Did Drake circumnavigate the globe for geographic science, national glory, or legalised piracy?"*	/ 10	/ 2	/ 2	Q2 Explain: / 12	/ 26
4	**KT3.4: Attempted colonisation of Virginia** *"Why did Walter Raleigh's first American colony at Roanoke collapse into disaster by 1586?"*	/ 10	/ 2	/ 2	Q3 Essay: / 20	/ 34
KEY TOPIC 3 CUMULATIVE ASSESSMENT TOTALS		**Do Now: / 40**	**Q1(a): / 8**	**Q1(b): / 8**	**Ext: / 64**	**/ 120**

TEACHER FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT • WWW / EBI FEEDBACK

WHAT WENT WELL (WWW):

_____

_____

_____

EVEN BETTER IF (EBI):

_____

_____

_____

Teacher Signature: _____ **Date:** _____

DIGITAL QUIZZING HUB • 20-QUESTION PRACTICE QUIZZES

Scan with smartphone camera to open live interactive 20-question self-marking quizzes

KT 3.1	KT 3.2	KT 3.3	KT 3.4
SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ	SCAN TO QUIZ
Score: / 20	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**	**Score: / 20**